

UNITY AND DUALITY

Greetings, my dearest friends. May this evening be a blessing and an enrichment for every one of you here and for all who read these words. May you open your minds and your hearts so that you can understand deep within yourself. And if you cannot understand immediately, some of these words may take root in your psyche, and the seeds may come to fruition later. Full understanding of this lecture may reach you only as you work your way through these deep layers of your unconscious where what I say here will find application within.

There are two basic ways for man to live, two basic approaches to life and to himself. Or to put it differently, there are two fundamental basic possibilities of consciousness in the human being. The one is the dualistic, the other is the unified plane of consciousness. We have often talked about some of these aspects, but let me briefly recapitulate some of them in both planes so as to make tonight's lecture more understandable.

The majority of human beings live predominantly on the dualistic plane. The dualistic plane means that man sees, perceives, and experiences everything in opposites. It is always either/or, good or bad, right or wrong, life or death. In other words, practically everything man encounters, every human problem and predicament, is determined by this dualistic way of perceiving life.

The unified principle combines both opposites of the dualistic plane. By transcending the dualistic plane of consciousness, it is found that the painfulness of it no longer exists. Few human beings transcend the dualistic plane and experience only occasionally a taste of the wide, limitless outlook, the wisdom and freedom of the unified plane.

In the unified plane of consciousness, there are no opposites. There is no good or bad, no right or wrong, no life or death. There is only good, only right, only life. Yet it is not the kind of good or the kind of right or the kind of life that comprises but one of the opposites of the dualistic planes. It transcends it and is of a completely different nature. That good, or that right, or that life which exists on the unified plane of consciousness combines both aspects of the dualistic way of life. In the unified state of mind, no conflict exists because the dualism is combined and the opposites no longer conflict with one another. This is why to live in a unified state, in absolute reality, is the bliss, the unlimited freedom, the fulfillment, and the unlimited realization of potentials that religion calls heaven. This heaven is usually thought to be a place in time and space. This, of course, is not so. It is a state of consciousness which can be realized any time in whatever shape an individual entity exists. By this, I mean a human being in the flesh, as well as one who does not live in a material body.

The unified state of consciousness is a question of understanding or, as I often term it, that of "knowingness." In the dualistic plane, life must be a continuous problem. The struggle man has is that of coping with the arbitrary and illusory division of the unified principle so that things become

opposites, and that imposes conflicts. It creates tension, fight within man and therefore with the outer world.

Let us understand this particular struggle a little better, and therefore the human predicament. There is a part in man -- regardless of how asleep, of how unconscious, and of how ignorant he may be of it -- there nevertheless is in man such a thing as a unified state of mind, or a real self, which is and lives in and expresses and manifests the unified principle. Now, even those who have never heard of such a thing, who are utterly ignorant of the terms or of their meaning have a deep longing and a deep, mostly unconscious sense of a different state of mind and of a different way of experiencing life than the one they know. They yearn for the state of freedom, the blissfulness, and the mastery of life that the unified state of consciousness affords.

However, this longing is misinterpreted by the personality. It is misinterpreted partly because it is an unconscious yearning for what may usually be termed as "happiness," "fulfillment." But let us understand precisely what is really meant by these words. It means the state of unification of the opposites on the dualistic plane so that there is no longer any struggle or effort, no fight, no tension, no conflict, no anxiety or fear. Consequently, the world is alive and the self is master -- not master in a tight, tense, hostile way, but master in the way that life can be exactly what the individual decides and determines it to be. This freedom, and this mastery, and this bliss, and this liberation from tension and agitation in the human soul are consciously and unconsciously longed for and striven for.

The misinterpretation of this longing exists partly because the knowledge of it is lacking. It is only a vague feeling deep within the soul. But even when the theoretical knowledge of such a state exists, it is still mostly misinterpreted for yet another reason. And that is the following reason, my friends. When freedom and mastery, unification and its resulting bliss, and manifestation of the unified state of consciousness are striven for and attempted on the dualistic plane, tremendous conflict must ensue because it is an absolute impossibility to accomplish. This is what mostly happens. Man strives for the fulfillment of his deep longing to transcend and find deep within himself a new state of consciousness in which all is one. When he seeks this on a plane in which all is divided, he cannot only never find what he seeks, but he must despair and split himself further apart in conflicts, for, as I have often said, illusion creates duality. This is overwhelmingly the case with these people who are ignorant of these possibilities, but it is also so with people who are more spiritually enlightened, and who are nevertheless ignorant of the distinct difference between these two planes, and who also ignore how in themselves and in their practical daily existence they can learn to transcend the dualistic plane.

When the vague longing for or the precise theoretical knowledge of the unified plane of consciousness is misread and therefore striven for on the dualistic plane, the following must happen. When man knows and senses that there is only good, freedom, right, beauty, love, truth, life without a threatening opposite, and when he tries to apply this on the dualistic plane, he will immediately be plunged into the very conflict of opposites he needs to avoid. He then fights for one of the dualistic aspects and against the other. Such a fight makes the transcendence impossible.

Let me demonstrate this in a familiar everyday human problem so that you can apply and understand these words in more than their abstract meaning. Man finds himself constantly plunged in issues with his surroundings. Let us assume a person is in a quarrel with a friend. He is

convinced, from where he sits, that he is right. Therefore, immediately, the friend becomes wrong. With man's dualistic understanding, it can only be either/or. The outcome seems to matter more than the particular issue, for when the intensity of emotions is truly tested, they often have no relationship to the issue at stake. They are commensurate with a life or death issue. Although man may think this irrational on a conscious level, unconsciously being wrong truly means being dead, for being wrong means to be denied by the other. On the dualistic plane, man's sense of identity is associated with the other person, not with his real self. As long as man experiences himself only as the outer ego self, he must depend on others, as I shall explain in greater detail a little later. Only when man has realized the center of his being, which is unification, does his life no longer depend on others. Hence, a slight quarrel becomes truly a matter of life or death, which explains the intensity of emotions and the intensity of proving his right and the other's wrong.

On the dualistic plane, each issue ends with either life or death. Life becomes so important so as to avoid death. Often death is feared so much that it is run into head on. Such individuals are not free from a fear of death. Quite the contrary, although their constant struggle with life -- a result of their struggle against death -- renders them sufficiently unhappy so that they believe not to fear death. This is an illusion as long as life is experienced on the dualistic plane, as long as one side is important and fought for and the other side threatening and is fought against, vanquished, triumphed over. In any issue you happen to be involved in, as long as you feel that you must win, that one is so while the other is not so, you are deeply involved in the world of duality, and therefore in a world of illusion, and therefore in constant strain and suffering, conflict and confusion. The more you fight in this way, the greater the confusion becomes.

Man is geared and habitually trained by himself, by his upbringing, by everything he learns, absorbs, and perceives in his surroundings, to fight for one and against the other of any number of opposites. This not only applies to material issues and physical manifestations of life, but even more to the subtle plane of concepts and understanding. As I have so often demonstrated, every truth can thus be divided into two opposites, one being adhered to as the "right idea," the opposite aspect being declared as the "wrong idea," while, in reality, they both complement one another. On the unified plane of truth and fulfillment, neither aspect is thinkable without the other, of which the complements are "enemies" only on the dualistic plane of consciousness.

Every conflict snowballs into intricate subconflicts, or subdivisions of the primary dualistic split. Since all this is a product of illusion, the more the conflict goes on, the less can it be solved -- hence, the more hopelessly enmeshed man becomes in it. Let us now return to our example and demonstrate how this is so. The more the man proves his friend wrong, the more friction exists, and the less does he obtain what he thought he would obtain by proving himself right and the other wrong. He believes that by proving himself right and the friend wrong, the friend will finally accept and love him again, and all will be well. When he does not succeed, he misinterprets that and tries harder, for he thinks he has not sufficiently proven his right and the other's wrong. The rift widens, his anxiety increases, and the more weapons he uses to win his fight, the deeper he gets into difficulties until he actually damages himself, the other, and acts against his best interest. He is then faced with a further conflict, which arises out of the first error and dualistic split. In order to avoid a total rift with all its real and imagined threats (for real damage has begun to be wrought), he is now faced with the alternative of having to give in in order to appease and avoid damage for himself, or to continue fighting. Since he is still convinced of a right versus a wrong, such appeasement robs him of self-respect, and he fights against that. Whether he uses this "solution" or not, he will be

torn between the two alternatives of fighting or submitting. Both create tension, anxiety, and inner and outer disadvantages.

Thus a new duality develops out of the first. The first is who is right and who is wrong; "Only I must be right, otherwise all is bad." The second is either giving in and assuming a wrong that he cannot admit, for it is a total right or a total wrong, or continuing this total fight. Admitting a wrong means death, in a sense. So he is faced with the alternatives of admitting a wrong (that means death in the deep psyche) in order to avoid dreaded consequences and the possibility of a real risk -- putting the life at a grave disadvantage (also death, in the deepest sense) -- or insisting on his total right. Any way he turns, he finds death, total disaster, loss, annihilation. The harder he fights for, and against, the less there is to fight for, and the more against him all alternatives become. The illusion that one side was good and the other bad has brought the inevitable next step on this road of illusion, which is that all is bad. That is the fate of all dualistic struggle, leading into further traps which are all products of illusion.

When the road to the unified principle is chosen, soon what first appeared as one good and one bad ceases to be so, and one inevitably encounters good and bad on both ends. And when this "road" is pursued still further, there no longer is any bad, but only good. The road leads deep inside into the real self, into truth that surpasses the fearful little ego interests. When this truth is sought deep inside of the self, the unified state of consciousness is approached. Our example is a banal one and can be translated into many, many everyday issues, big or small. It exists in a small squabble between two mates. It exists in a conflict between two countries at war. It exists in all difficulties mankind is engaged in individually and collectively. As long as a person finds himself in this dualistic, illusory conflict, there must be hopelessness, for there is no way out -- on the dualistic plane of thinking. As long as man's very existence is identified with the ego self and therefore with the dualistic approach to life, he cannot help but despair, no matter how much this despair is covered up or momentarily alleviated by occasional success in "winning" on the desirable alternative of the two opposites. The helplessness and hopelessness, the wasted energy of the dualistic struggle, rob man of his birthright. This birthright he can only find on the plane of unification.

Since all rules and precepts, everything man learns and absorbs in his education and environment, are geared to dualistic standards, it is not surprising that he is totally attached and adapted to this state of consciousness. And even when he learns and hears about this other possibility, he is frightened of it. He cannot believe in it and clings to that which he knows. Here a vicious circle exists in that the dualistic rules and precepts, which condition man to this way of life, are in themselves a result of man's fear of giving up the egotistical state which, alone, seems to guarantee him life. It appears to him that giving up this ego state means annihilation of his individuality which, of course, is utterly erroneous. So man has these rules because of his erroneous fears, and he clings to the false fears because of his indoctrination.

Before we discuss in greater detail why man clings to the painful dualistic state in spite of the immediate and the direct possibility of the unified plane of consciousness, I would like to say more about the latter and discuss how to realize it within yourself. What we call the real self, or the divine substance in man, or the divine principle, or the infinite intelligence, or any number of other names mankind has chosen for the deep inner live-center, exists in every human being. It contains all wisdom and truth that man can possibly envisage. The truth is of such far-reaching nature and so directly accessible that no further conflict exists where and when this truth is allowed to take effect.

There ceases to exist any if's and but's of the dualistic state of life. The knowing of this inborn intelligence is of such nature that it surpasses the ego intelligence. It is completely objective, it disregards the small, vain self-interest -- and this is one of the reasons it is feared and man avoids contact with it. The truth that flows out of it equalizes the self with others in a way that not only is not the annihilation that the ego fears, but it opens up the storehouse of vibrant life force and energy that man usually disposes of only to a minor degree and which he misuses in directing his attention and his hopes to the dualistic plane -- the plane of the ego with its tightly held opinions, conclusions, its false ideas, its vanity, its pride, self-will, and fear. When this live-center activates man, he begins his limitless unfoldment, whose accomplishments become possible precisely because the little ego no longer needs them for its enhancement in order to find life on the dualistic plane.

The unified real self can always be contacted, in every issue of man's life. Let us again return to our example in order to see exactly how this could be done in such a case. The act which appears to be the most difficult for man to perform, but which, in reality, is the easiest and most unstrained act possible, is to ask precisely "What is the truth of the matter?" The moment an individual is more bent on the truth than on proving his right, he contacts the divine principle of transcendent, unified truth. If the desire to be in truth is genuine, the inspiration must come forth. No matter how much circumstances seem to point in one direction, man must be willing to relinquish and question that what he sees is all there is to the issue. This generous act of integrity opens the way to the real self. This act will be easier to follow through when man contemplates that it is not necessarily a question of either/or, but that there may be aspects of right in the other and of wrong in himself that, so far, he has not seen because his attention was not even directed to this eventuality. With this approach to a problem, man immediately opens the way to enter into the unified plane of existence and to be moved by the real self. This immediately releases an energy which is distinctly felt when this act is really committed to in a deep and sincere way. It brings release of tension. What he then finds out is always totally different from both what he hoped for and feared against on the dualistic plane. He finds that he is not as right and innocent as he thought, nor as wrong as he feared. Nor is the opponent. He soon discovers aspects in the matter that he never saw before although they were not necessarily concealed. He understands exactly how the quarrel came into existence in the first place, what led to it, what was its history long before its actual manifestation. With this, he gains insight into the very nature of the relationship, he learns about himself and the other, and he increases his understanding of the laws of intercommunication. The more vision he thus gains, the freer, stronger, and more secure does he feel. This vision not only eliminates this particular conflict and shows the right way and approach to straighten it out, but it also reveals important aspects of this person's general difficulties whose elimination becomes easier through this experience and its understanding. The vibrant peace through this extended understanding is of lasting value. It affects man's self-realization and has its beneficial results in his daily life as well. This is a typical example of unified, intuitive understanding and knowing the truth. After the initial apparent need for courage and the momentary resistance to seeing a wider truth than the egotistic one, it is so much easier than the struggle that ensues on the either/or plane of life.

Before you can bring yourself to that way of thinking and being, the tension will mount, for as long as you are still on the dualistic plane, you struggle against this way of thinking because you believe falsely that the moment you admit and see a wrong in you and a right in the other, you submit and enslave yourself. You become nothing, worthless, pitiful; and from there it is only a step to annihilation in your fantasy life. Hence, you feel it as the greatest of danger to leave your dualistic plane. The tension must mount the more the conflicts tear you in several directions at once. But

the moment you are willing to be in truth, the moment you are eager and prepared not to see merely your way, your little truth, nor to give in to the other's little truth in fear of the consequences when you do not, but when you wish to be in possession of the larger, more encompassing truth which transcends both of your little truths, in that moment a specific tension will be removed in your psyche. The way toward the manifestation of the real self will be prepared.

Let me recapitulate here what I have often mentioned previously. The two most significant obstructions to the real self are ignorance of its existence and of the possibility to be connected with it, and a tight, cramped psychic state with tight, cramped soul movements. These two factors make contact impossible with the real self and therefore with a unified state of existence. As long as you are in a dualistic plane, you must constantly be in a soul cramp. You may remember how often I discussed the importance of observing your soul movement. When you fight against one dual aspect and press for the other, observe the soul movements coming forth. Superficially, you may lean on the apparent justification of what you press for. You may say, "Is it not perfectly justified and right that I am against this wrong in the world?" On the dualistic plane, this may indeed be so. But in this limited outlook, you ignore that this very wrong exists only because of this type of approach to the problem and the prevalent ignorance that there is another approach. The resulting tension blurs the view that other aspects exist which unify that which you deem right and that which you deem wrong -- regardless of what the wrong actually is.

This simple act of wanting the truth requires several factors, the most important of which is the willingness to relinquish what one holds on to -- whether this be a belief, a conviction, a fear, a cherished way of being. When I say relinquish, I merely mean questioning it and being willing to see that there is something else beyond this outlook and that conviction. This brings us back to what I said I shall discuss, namely, why is man so terrified to relinquish the ego state, hence the dualistic, painful way of life? Why does he fear and resist so much entrusting and committing himself to this deep inner center which is a reality, which combines and unifies all good, and which is instantly accessible? However, it is beyond the personal, little considerations of the ego.

As I have said, the dualistic plane is the plane of the ego. The unified plane is the world of the divine center, of the larger self. The ego finds its whole existence on the plane in which it is at home. To give up this plane means to give up the claims of the little ego. This does not mean its annihilation, but to the ego it seems to mean this. Actually the ego is a particle, an isolated aspect of the master intelligence, of the real, inner self. It is not different from it, only there is less of the real self in it. Since it is separated, disconnected, and limited, it is less reliable and secure than that from which it stems. But this does not mean that it needs to be annihilated. In actual fact, it will integrate with the real self so that there is one -- this "one" being fuller, better equipped, wiser, having more and better of all assets imaginable. But the separated ego thinks this means its annihilation, its ceasing to exist. In its ignorant, limited way, it feels existence only as the separated being -- hence it pursues further separateness. I know that I have said all this many times before, but in the context of this lecture it is, once again, important to think about and apply this to our topic. Since consciousness ignores the existence of the real self (even if it is accepted as a theory, its living reality must be doubted as long as personal misconceptions are not eliminated), it fears the very soul movement of letting go and relaxing of the tight hold that leads to the realization of the real self. This is the constant struggle of the ego until it ceases fighting against an opposite, through repeated recognition of a wider truth in every smallest personal issue.

As you heard me say many times, the real self cannot manifest as long as involved personal inner difficulties and problems are not straightened out. But the process of doing this and the beginning of the first inklings of self-realization often overlap; the one furthers the other. Many of my friends can utilize these words in a new approach to their problems although there is nothing new in my words as such. However, this specific way of looking at your basic human struggle may help you considerably further.

As long as man is totally identified with his separated ego, he must, as I said, cultivate more separation -- hence self-idealization must be a consequence. Self-glorification and idealization is, from this point of view, then, the apparent salvation and guarantee to assuage your existential fears. To put this in simpler terms, the ego thinks, "If everyone around me thinks that I am special" -- especially good, or smart, or beautiful, or talented, or happy, unhappy, or even bad, or whatever the specialty you have chosen for your own personal idealized self-glorification -- "then I will receive the necessary approval, love, admiration, agreement that I need in order to live." This means that somewhere deep down you believe that you can exist only through being noticed, affirmed, and confirmed by others. You feel that if you go by unnoticed, if no one knows of your existence, you cease to live. This may sound exaggerated, but it is not. It explains why some people's idealized self-image is destructive and negative. They feel more confident in making themselves noticed than through positive specialness. So your salvation seems to lie in others who would acknowledge your existence only if you are different -- that is, special. At the same time, the misinterpreted message from the real self wants you to master life, but you master it on the wrong plane and believe that you must vanquish every resistance that is put in your way. Each personal pseudosolution is a way in which you hope to eliminate the obstructions put in your way. Which pseudosolution you have chosen depends on individual character traits, on circumstances and early influences. Whatever they are -- and you know that there are three basic ones, the aggressive, the submissive, and the withdrawal solutions -- they are designed to triumph over others and establish your "freedom" and "fulfillment" in this way. You seem to be guaranteed your existence when you are totally loved, accepted, and served by others; and this you hope to attain by triumphing over them. You see that you are governed by a succession of wrong conclusions, which are all completely different in reality. Of course, all these reactions and beliefs in you can only be ascertained as existing when you have learned to admit them, when you question the meaning of a particular reaction and look behind the facade and beyond what you pretend they mean. Once this admission is made, it is easy to verify that all these misconceptions govern you and rob you of the beauty of reality. You will further come to see -- not as a theory, but as a reality experience -- that your life does not depend on other people's affirmation of your existence; that you do not need to be special and separated from others; that this very claim traps you into loneliness and confusion; that others will give you love and acceptance only when you do not wish to be better than they are, or special or different from them. Also, this love will come when your very life no longer depends on it.

When you have truly attained knowledge, when you are truly accomplished in whatever field this may be, it cannot have the effect on others that it has when accomplishment serves to set you apart. In the one case, your accomplishment will be a bridge to others because it is not a weapon against them. In the other instance, it will create antagonism because you wish to be accomplished in order to be better than others -- which always means that others should be less. When you need to be better through your accomplishments, what you give to the world must turn against you because you offer it in a spirit of war. When you give of your accomplishments in order to enrich life and others, you and your life will be enhanced by it because what you offer is given in a spirit of

peace. In the latter case, you become a part of life. In taking from life -- the live-center within yourself -- and giving it back to life as an integral part of it, you act according to the unified principle.

Whenever the struggle exists "in order to live I must be better than others, I must be separate," disappointment is inevitable. It cannot bring the desired result because it is based on illusion. The dualistic concept is "me versus the other." It is this illusory belief which makes the transition from the dualistic to the unified plane of consciousness so difficult, for giving up this fight against the other appears to imply the annihilation of self. The more the other is fought against, the less will he comply with the demand and expectation of affirming the self, and the more will this be experienced as a danger equal to the alternative of giving up the fight itself. So every way man turns to seems to be blocked. He makes himself utterly dependent on others due to the illusory concept that otherwise he is lost, while at the same time trying to overrun and triumph over them. He must resent the former and feel guilt about the latter. Both create intense frustrations and anxiety, both yield no salvation whatever.

Notice the initial disinclination to question your assumptions concerning any problematic issue in your life. The outer quarrel or issue is so painful only because the inner quarrel is one between life and death -- or so you believe. The fallacy of this quarrel can be established only when you dare to question your reactions honestly and precisely. Even though some of you are quite accomplished in this pathwork, in self-facing up to a degree, you still manage to hide the issue when it becomes really painful and frightening. And this is your very stumbling block because your shying away from what appears so painful and frightening makes it impossible to uncover the fallacy of your hidden belief. What you hold on to secretly, born out of your dualistic outlook and the thus ensuing inner battle, gives you the cramped inner movement which debilitates you. It paralyzes your free flowing energies and makes the transition into the unified plane impossible. When you look at your problems in a way as objective and detached as you can muster, expressing the wider outlook of the real self, when you turn your best intent and will to the matter that disturbs you in a genuine wish for impartiality, you will first notice a shrinking back from such a desire and a more or less overt or subtle way of covering up your desire for flight. Catch yourself in this act and courageously forge on, questioning yourself further and deeper. You will then come to see that, finally, the outer quarrel or difficulty is a symbolic representation of the inner quarrel in you in which you fight for life against death, for existence against annihilation. You will see what you evidently believe is required from others in order for you to exist. When you have arrived at this level of your being, you will be able to question your precepts that lay the foundation for this. And this is the first step to enable the transition from the dualistic error into the unified truth. You will further notice that relinquishing ideals, deals, and convictions also looks like annihilation, for being wrong means dying, being right means living. The moment you go through this opening up movement, and you have the courage to want the truth, and you envisage the possibility of a wider and more complete truth than you can see at the moment, in whatever the issue is, you will come to a new peace and a new intuitive knowledge about the way things are. Something in your hardened psychic material will have loosened up and further prepares the way for total self-realization. Each time you loosen up, it will become a little easier, and the climate in your psyche is more auspicious for the final total awakening into your inner center of all life, all truth, of the unified good of creation. Every step in this direction abandons another misconception, and each misconception represents another burden. The giving up of what first seemed like security and protection from annihilation will now be disclosed as what it really is -- burden, suffering, imprisonment. You then comprehend the

preposterous fact that you are actually opposed to leaving the dualistic life, with all its hardship, its hopelessness. Perhaps you can now understand some of this, and this will help you in your personal path. When you apply this to your everyday life, you will see that the abstract sounding words I use here are not something far away, but accessible for everyone of you. You will see that these words are practical and concrete if only you are willing to see yourself in relationship to life in a wider truth than you are as yet willing to even contemplate.

On the dualistic plane you must have everything your way. You must win over life, over others, over circumstances. You must prove yourself to be stronger than all other factors in your surrounding life which may oppose you. Opposing you means that you lose; and losing, in the last analysis, means your nonexistence. That is what you are frightened of and why you are so intense in the struggle. That is why you feel always as though something much larger is at stake than the actual issue. This is why you deny the intensity of your emotions, knowing that what takes place on the conscious level is not commensurate with your real reactions. If, at times, you win over the circumstances, is it really enduring peace you gain? Not really, my friends.

At the moment, you may be gratified and appeased and feel safe. But how long can you remain master over life under dualistic principles? The next issue endangers you all over again, and deep inside you know this, only you know it in the false way -- in the way that you believe this to be your undoing. You must therefore constantly live in fear that you cannot always win. In this dependency in which you need life to be always according to your needs, or rather your imagined needs, so as to master it, you must become resentful of those who prohibit your gratification. You must be resentful of life which does not let you be. The message coming from the real self says, "Your birthright is perfect happiness, freedom, and mastery over life." When you fight for this birthright under dualistic principles, you remove yourself further and further from the realization of yourself, in which you could truly have mastery, freedom, and total fulfillment of yourself. You seek all this with false means. They are as varied as are individuals and their characters. In all these years, we discussed many of these false means, the pseudosolutions, for example. If you restudy them in the light of this lecture, you will understand on a deeper level what this is all about. You will see how you personally try to accomplish the fight, the false fight leading into more confusion and pain. The three basic pseudosolutions are but means for conquering life on the dualistic plane so as to guarantee your existence. The overt fight is not a bit more opposed to truth and peace, not one iota less aggressive than the submissive solution, whose hostility always smolders underground. Whatever your ways to win, you are dependant on others and on circumstances often way beyond your actual control and therefore doomed to failure. This anxiety and futile struggle makes your psychic material brittle, hardened. The more this is so, the less are you able to contact the center of your inner being where all is found that you could possibly need, where you find vital well being and productivity, the peace of inner relaxation which is an integral by-product of the real self.

The only way you can truly enter into the unitive state of life, in which you can truly be master, is by no longer needing to triumph, to win, to be separate, to be special, to be right, to have it your way, by finding and discovering the need in all situations, whatever they are, whether you deem them good or bad, right or wrong. Needless to say, this does not mean resignation, nor does it mean fearful giving in or weakness. It means going with the stream of life and coping with what is as yet beyond your immediate control, whether or not it is according to your liking. It means accepting where you are and what life is for you at this moment. It means being in harmony with your own inner rhythm. This will open the channel so that finally total self-realization takes place.

This means that all your expressions in life are motivated and lived through by the divine principle operating in you and expressing through your individuality, integrating your ego faculties with this universal self. This enhances your individuality, it does not diminish it. It enhances every one of your pleasures, it takes nothing away from you whatever.

May every one of you comprehend that the truth is in you, everything you need is in you. May you find that you actually do not have to fight and struggle as you constantly do. All you have to do is see and recognize the truth wherever you stand now. All you have to do at this time is see that there may be more than you see and call upon this inner center and allow yourself to be open to its intuitive messages to you. May you find this possible exactly where you need it most at this particular moment. Your gauge is always that which feels most uncomfortable and from which you are most tempted to look away. Be blessed, continue your wonderful path, that path which will bring you to the realization that you already have what you need and are where you need to be. You merely look away because you are geared in the opposite direction. Be in peace. Be in God.

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